book also covers alternative mechanisms for making CORS requests, such as images in canvas elements, media uploads, and using JQuery.

- *CORS from the server*—The server uses HTTP headers to control CORS behavior. HTTP headers can be used to indicate things like which HTTP methods are allowed, whether cookies can be included on requests, and whether cross-origin requests are allowed at all. This book takes an in-depth look at what these headers are and how they're used.
- *Debugging CORS requests*—Because CORS has client and server components, it can sometimes be difficult to debug CORS issues when things go wrong. This book ends with a look at how to debug issues with CORS requests. It introduces such tools as the browser's debugging tools, Wireshark, and Fiddler.

What this book won't give you

This book isn't an introduction to JavaScript or the web. This doesn't mean you need to be a JavaScript expert. It assumes that you have a basic understanding of how the web, HTTP requests, and JavaScript work.

Although this book uses Node.js and Express for the sample code, you won't find fully programmed CORS solutions for your specific language or platform (unless, of course, you happen to be using Node.js and Express). The core concepts of CORS are the same regardless of what web platform or programming language you use. The goal of this book is to give you the foundation for understanding CORS, so that you can then go off and implement it on your own platform.

How to read this book

Because this book is an overview of CORS, you can approach it from different perspectives:

- *API owners*—Whether you maintain an existing API or are building a new API from scratch, CORS is a great way to extend your API's reach.
- *API consumers*—Building dynamic sites on top of APIs can sometimes be difficult. CORS can make this easier by giving developers a pure JavaScript mechanism for making API requests.
- *JavaScript developers*—Even if you aren't making CORS requests, JavaScript developers can benefit from understanding the basics of how `XMLHttpRequest` and CORS work. Most modern web pages are built on top of asynchronous HTTP requests (AJAX), and it's useful to have CORS as another tool in your toolbox.

Roadmap

This book is divided into three parts. The first part looks at how to make CORS requests from the browser. The second part looks at how to add CORS support to a server. The third part looks at how to debug CORS requests.